

Tools to Ensure the Security of Web Applications

Web applications have the potential to reach a wider spectrum of users in comparison to desktop apps, and hence have become a popular platform to render various services. However, the security of these applications needs to be ensured for people to feel confident enough to use them for sensitive tasks such as financial transactions. This article introduces readers to five tools associated with Web application security—Grabber, w3af, Zed Attack Proxy, sqlmap and Wapiti.



Grabber

Grabber is a scanner for Web applications. It is a simple tool that locates vulnerabilities in a Web application. The following is a list of all that Grabber can handle:

- Cross-site scripting
 - SQL injection
 - File inclusion
 - Preliminary AJAX checking
 - JavaScript source code analysis
- Grabber can be downloaded from <http://rgaucher.info/beta/grabber/Grabber.zip>.

After the installation process, it can be executed as follows:

```
$ python grabber.py --spider 1 --sql
--xss --url http://127.0.0.1/bank
```

Otherwise, the parameters can be configured through a configuration file, as shown below:

```
<grabber version="0.1">
  <site>
    <url> http://127.0.0.1/bank </url>
    <spider> 1 </spider> <!-- Depth of
the spider -->
    <scan>
      <xss /> <sql />
    </scan>
  </site>
</grabber>
```

Grabber is designed to scan websites that have just a few pages

Web applications simplify the process of delivering online services to a wide range of users, and do so effectively. In comparison to their desktop counterparts, Web applications have various advantages. Some of them are listed below:

- Web applications don't require any installation on the user's machine.
- The hardware requirement of the Web applications is also very minimal. As they run inside a browser, Web apps are generally platform-neutral.
- In the case of desktop applications, one of the major problems is updating to the latest version. As Web apps are not locally installed,

users do not need to update them.

Due to these advantages, Web applications have emerged as a popular mode of delivering services. However, security is one of the critical aspects to concentrate on in this scenario. Compared to desktop apps, the security for Web applications is more critical as they are vulnerable to all kinds of online attacks.

There are plenty of tools to analyse the security of Web applications. This article provides an introduction to the following open source security tools associated with Web applications:

- Grabber
- w3af
- Zed Attack Proxy
- sqlmap
- Wapiti